

Javier Donado

Engineering & People Leader · Solution Architect

Stuttgart, Germany Spanish and German citizenship jdonado@jdonado.com <https://www.jdonado.com>

<https://github.com/mrdonado>

SUMMARY

Solution Architect and Engineering Lead with close to 20 years of experience in software architecture, digital product development, and technical leadership at scale. Applies systems thinking to identify hidden constraints, untangle inter-team dependencies, and design environments where teams can own and deliver end to end. Known for driving engineering culture as a strategic lever — from DORA metrics and communities of practice to feedback culture and AI-driven workflows. Experienced in leading teams of teams, influencing architecture across organisations, and aligning technical strategy with business goals.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Architecture

Solution architecture, software architecture, cloud-native systems, frontend architecture, integration architecture, API design, platform modernization, system design, architecture alignment.

Systems Thinking & Culture

Systems thinking, constraint identification, dependency mapping, organisational design, engineering culture, communities of practice, DORA metrics, SRE, blameless post-mortems, feedback culture, AI-driven workflows.

Technical Leadership

Technical strategy, team leadership, mentoring, engineering coaching, architecture guidance, code quality, technical decision-making, stakeholder alignment, cross-functional collaboration, technical interviewing.

Product & Delivery

Digital product development, Lean product development, experimentation, data-driven decision-making, customer-centric solutions, agile delivery, discovery-to-delivery alignment.

Communication & Languages

Stakeholder management, executive communication, storytelling, negotiation, technical writing. Native Spanish speaker, fluent in English and German, currently learning Greek.

SELECTED IMPACT

- Led architecture and technical direction across multiple Porsche.com Agile Release Trains — including PCOM, Brand and Model, and Brand Platform — spanning 5 to 8 product and system teams.
- Applied systems thinking to identify hidden bottlenecks — in content delivery chains, homepage dependencies, model pages, and technical data integrations — that silently prevented teams from working in parallel; redesigned both architecture and delivery processes to remove them.
- Led the transformation of Porsche.com from a tightly coupled, on-premises setup where strong inter-team dependencies made independent delivery nearly impossible, to a cloud-native, verticalized architecture where teams own and ship their products end to end.
- Championed engineering culture as a strategic lever: established communities of practice, introduced DORA metrics and SRE practices, drove AI-driven workflows, normalised blameless post-mortems, and coached engineers on ownership, feedback, and trust.
- Architectural patterns established for Porsche.com attracted cross-group interest, with active evaluation by Audi and alignment sessions with Volkswagen Group engineering teams.
- Act as direct-line manager (People Lead) for eight colleagues specialised in AI and Software Engineering — conducting 1-on-1s, supporting career development, and writing performance reviews alongside the main Solution Architect role.
- Conducted hundreds of technical interviews over the years for roles spanning junior frontend developer to senior architect, across backend, frontend, and all things software engineering — contributing directly to hiring quality and team growth.
- Built and led teams of teams across multiple companies and industries over nearly two decades — consistently improving engineering practices and contributing to the delivery of impactful digital products.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Porsche Digital GmbH

Ludwigsburg, Germany · 02/2018 – Present

Solution Architect | Porsche.com Brand and Model ART

07/2021 – Present

As Solution Architect across multiple Porsche.com Agile Release Trains, I lead the technical direction of multidisciplinary product and system teams and ensure alignment between architecture, engineering execution, and business goals.

- Led architecture and technical direction across multiple Porsche.com ARTs — including PCOM, Brand and Model, and Brand Platform — spanning 5 to 8 product and system teams.
- Applied systems thinking to uncover hidden bottlenecks in content delivery chains, homepage dependencies, and technical data integrations that silently blocked parallel team work; redesigned architecture and delivery processes to remove them.
- Led the transformation of Porsche.com from a tightly coupled, on-premises setup to a cloud-native, verticalized architecture where teams own and ship their products end to end.
- Championed engineering culture improvements: established communities of practice, introduced DORA metrics and SRE practices, drove AI-driven workflows, and normalised blameless post-mortems.
- Drove cross-group architectural alignment, with active evaluation of Porsche.com patterns by Audi and joint sessions with Volkswagen Group engineering teams.
- Managed the adoption of modern frontend and cloud technologies, practices, and architecture patterns.
- Contributed to significant improvements in performance, accessibility, and reliability.

Engineering

Web (full-stack) and mobile development, TypeScript, Python, TDD, cloud development, DevOps practices, automation, quality assurance, software integration. Familiar with most mainstream frameworks and tooling across the stack.

LANGUAGES

Spanish	Native
English	C1
German	C1
Greek	Learning

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

2022–present Hands-on exploration of AI-driven workflows, LLMs, prompt engineering, agentic workflows (OpenClaw, Hermes, and others), and AI-assisted development — applied to professional projects and personal experiments.

2023–present Personal knowledge management with Obsidian — structured note-taking, idea linking, and maintaining a personal knowledge base.

07/2021 Certified SAFe 5 Architect

2014–present Continuous learning via online platforms (50+ courses across cloud architecture, AI/ML, frontend, leadership, and software design).

2014–present Open-source side projects and experiments

06/2013 ISTQB Certified Tester, Foundation Level , Stuttgart

05/2011 Certificate in Advanced English, CAE C1 , Madrid

ADDITIONAL

DRIVING LICENSE

Category B

INTERESTS

Science and technology, travel (34 countries and counting), music, photography, guitar playing, music composition, home recording, and foosball (Kicker! 🎱).

- Helped position Porsche.com as a leading digital platform within the automotive industry.
- Act as direct-line manager (People Lead) for eight colleagues specialised in AI and Software Engineering — conducting 1-on-1s, supporting career development, and writing performance reviews alongside the main Solution Architect role.
- Support colleagues ranging from junior professionals to seasoned experts with over 20 years of experience.

Systems ThinkingTeam TopologiesDDDAAWSAzureSAFeDORA Metrics

SREADRsRadical CandorEvent StormingMicro-frontendsCI/CDNext.js

ReactTypeScriptSSRSSGHeadless CMSGitHub CopilotCursor

Claude CodeCodex

Senior Full-stack Engineer and Tech Lead | New Business and Customer Innovation02/2018 – 06/2021

As Senior Full-stack Engineer and Tech Lead, I contributed to the creation of innovative digital products by translating early concepts into robust, customer-centric solutions.

- Developed digital products in cross-functional teams using Lean principles.
- Helped establish a culture of experimentation and data-driven decision-making.
- Optimized value delivery while maintaining adaptability in uncertain product environments.
- Provided technical leadership across web, mobile, backend, and cloud technologies.
- Supported the successful delivery of multiple digital products through hands-on engineering and technical guidance.

iOS developmentReact NativeReact.jsSpring BootNode.jsAWS Cognito

AWS DynamoDBAWS LambdaAmazon S3Amazon ECSAWS Fargate

AWS AmplifyAmazon CloudWatchCloudFoundryKubernetesJavaScript

TypeScriptKotlinJavaMongoDBRabbitMQ

netvico GmbH

Stuttgart, Germany · 06/2014 – 01/2018

Software Developer | Team Lead from 10/201606/2014 – 01/2018

At netvico GmbH, I worked as a software developer and later as Team Lead, combining hands-on development with team coordination, technical planning, and engineering process improvement.

- Managed and mentored a team of developers while remaining actively involved in software development.
- Contributed to project planning, architecture, and implementation of digital products.
- Helped professionalize software development practices by improving processes and methodologies.
- Increased engineering efficiency and product quality through more structured development workflows.
- Delivered products and solutions for clients including Vögele Shoes, Daimler, and Deutsche Bahn.
- Successfully bridged hands-on software engineering, customer needs, and team leadership in a growing product environment.

JavaScriptTypeScriptAngularReactNode.jsjQueryLodashMeteor

d3.jsSASSDockerC#PythonGitJenkinsMySQLMongoDB

mm-lab GmbH

Kornwestheim, Germany · 09/2012 – 06/2014

Software Engineer09/2012 – 06/2014

At mm-lab GmbH, I developed and integrated software solutions for the automotive industry, with a focus on automotive test track management systems and vehicle telematics.

- Contributed to the development and integration of automotive software solutions.
- Specialized in test track management systems and operational software for vehicle-related environments.
- Took responsibility for Linux administration and quality assurance engineering.
- Helped ensure stable operation, maintainability, and performance of software products.
- Worked successfully in a technically demanding domain that required reliability, integration discipline, and close attention to operational quality.

LinuxShell ScriptingVirtualizationC++GitSVNMySQLPerlPHP

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Daedalus – Data, Decisions and Language

Madrid, Spain · 05/2011 – 08/2012

Software Analyst

- Contributed to NLP products and R&D projects involving both frontend and backend development.
- Worked across product development, maintenance, and research-oriented implementation tasks.
- Applied a broad technical stack across Java, Linux, databases, web technologies, and service integrations.
- Succeeded in an R&D-heavy environment by combining analytical thinking, software engineering, and adaptability across different parts of the stack.

Java Linux MySQL PHP LAMP stack JavaScript jQuery Visual C#
Visual C++ Git REST SOAP web services

Primeur

Madrid, Spain · 04/2010 – 05/2011

Programmer Analyst

- Developed backend solutions for enterprise integration and SOA environments.
- Worked with IBM WebSphere Message Broker, IBM MQ, ESQL, Java, C#, and SQL.
- Delivered software integration consulting work for clients including IBM, El Corte Inglés, Repsol/YPF, and Mitsubishi Motors.
- Built a strong foundation in enterprise architecture, messaging systems, integration patterns, and backend reliability.
- Succeeded by learning complex enterprise technologies quickly and applying them in client-facing delivery contexts.

IBM WebSphere Message Broker IBM MQ ESQL Java C# SQL

Deimos Space

Tres Cantos, Madrid, Spain · 03/2008 – 08/2008

Research Internship

- Participated in R&D activities related to advanced communication systems.
- Worked on projects including SESAMO and BAIP2020.
- Contributed to research involving satellite mobility systems and wireless sensor networks.
- Gained early experience in high-tech engineering environments where rigor, technical curiosity, and structured problem-solving were essential.

EDUCATION

Universidad Carlos III de Madrid

Madrid, Spain · 09/2009

MS in Telecommunications Engineering, majoring in Telecommunication Systems

5-year degree, pre-Bologna system · ISCED 7 / EQF Level 7

The Telecommunications Engineering degree provided comprehensive theoretical knowledge and practical skills in information transmission and processing. It covered telecommunications technologies, networks, system design, architecture and integration, software engineering, and cybersecurity.

Thesis: Design and development of a Java application for the harmonic analysis of musical scores · With Honors, MH

Telecommunications Signal Processing Networks & Protocols Computer Architecture
Microprocessors Electronics Digital Systems Software Engineering C / C++
MATLAB Linux Cybersecurity